

neurodivers³

The Good-Day Conversation

The bad-day protocol works best if the conversation happens before the bad day.

How to agree a signal and a plan while you still have the words.

Why this conversation matters

The bad-day protocol works best if the conversation happens before the bad day.

A bad-day protocol is not about making someone responsible for you. It is about reducing guessing. When people do not know what is happening, they often ask more questions, move closer, try to fix it, or panic. Sometimes that comes from care. Sometimes it still makes the situation harder. This conversation gives the people around you a map before anyone needs it.

What this protects:

- your energy
- their confusion
- the relationship
- the moment when words are not available
- the need to explain while already overloaded

You are not asking someone to read your mind. You are giving them the instructions while you still have words.

The script

SCRIPT

There is something I want to tell you on a good day so we do not have to figure it out on a bad one.

Sometimes I cannot speak or explain properly. It is not about you, and it is not a choice. When that happens, you will see [SIGNAL].

When you see it, I would like you to [ACTION]. I do not need you to fix it. I need you to know what is happening.

Can we agree on this now, while I can talk about it?

My signal

The action I want

The version I am most likely to use

Optional edits:

- **Warmer version** — I know this might sound a bit formal, but it would really help me feel safer with you.
- **Firmer version** — When I use the signal, I need fewer questions, not more. We can talk about it later.
- **Work-safe version** — When I send this status, it means I am low on communication capacity. I will respond when I can give a clearer answer.

Pushbacks and replies

"That feels distant."

I get why it might feel that way. It is actually meant to keep me connected without forcing me to perform connection when I have no capacity.

"Can't you just tell me?"

Sometimes I can. This is for the times when I cannot. Having a signal means I do not have to build a sentence from nothing.

"Is this normal?"

It is normal for me. I am trying to give you clearer information instead of disappearing or pushing through.

"How often does it happen?"

It varies. The point is not to predict every bad day. It is to make the next one less confusing.

Closing advice:

If this conversation feels awkward, that does not mean it is wrong. Most useful access needs sound a bit strange the first time we say them out loud. — Ollie

Before you go

Where this fits

Bad-Day Protocol

The printable plan you just agreed.

neurodivers3.co.uk/store

Signals & Status Messages

The short messages to use day to day.

neurodivers3.co.uk/store

Masking Recovery Pack

For the recovery after.

neurodivers3.co.uk/store

Newsletter

One honest email when there's something worth saying.

neurodivers3.co.uk/newsletter

About neurodivers³

neurodivers³ is a home for honest stories, practical tools, and ideas for making everyday life work better with a neurodivergent brain. I make resources for late-diagnosed and self-identified neurodivergent adults who are tired of being told to try harder at systems that were never built for them. This guide is not a clinical tool. It is a practical one. Use what helps; leave what does not.

— Ollie

Feedback invitation:

If this conversation went better than you expected, or didn't, I'd like to hear at

hello@neurodivers3.co.uk.

Refundable for 14 days, no questions. Email hello@neurodivers3.co.uk within 14 days of purchase.